

FAMILY, FEMINISM, & IDENTITY: THE TATTOOS OF MISS MIA

By Milo Madolora



INTRODUCTION

Miss Mia is often one of the first people you meet at Legacy Magnet Academy, sitting at the front desk to greet and guide incoming students and parents. One of the first things you may notice about her is her tattoo sleeve. “My arm is dedicated to my son, my mom, and my grandpa,” she states. These tattoos serve as memories and reminders—a visual representation of the people who have touched her life. Each tattoo follows a basic theme of realism: depictions of real-life objects tied to feminism, family, and her identity.

Feminity

First, we discussed her favorite tattoos and the meanings behind them. Of all her tattoos, her favorite is the one most recently done. It's a collage of flowers that cascade down her arm, a representation of femininity. Miss Mia shares that she is starting a leg sleeve that will continue this theme of “more like Mother Nature, the power of a woman.” She got this inspiration from a

tattoo artist named Juli, who shares a similar realism-based tattoo ethos, though taken to a greater extent than Miss Mia's own.



Family

Next, I asked about the tattoos dedicated to her family. One tattoo adorning her skin is a beautiful butterfly silhouette, dedicated to her grandpa. As she puts it, “It’s a symbol of my grandpa when he died. On the day of his passing, one landed on me, and each day I look at it, it reminds me of his life.” Another tattoo is dedicated to her mother, featuring the words “I love you” written in her mother’s handwriting. The name “King” is tattooed on her shoulder, representing her son. There is also an angel wing in honor of her grandfather.



Ideas

Lastly, Miss Mia's tattoos represent phrases and ideas she lives by. Her first tattoo, a feather inked on her ribs, serves as a reminder that "you have to fall before you fly." Among all her tattoos, the phrase that resonates most with her is "don't judge a book by its cover." This belief is why she chooses to make all her tattoos visible—to challenge the negative connotations often associated with tattoos, and to contrast them with the warmth of her personality.

CONCLUSION

In conclusion, Miss Mia's tattoos are an extension of her identity: her family, her feminism, and her ideas. Through this art, she creates a visual narrative permanently connected to who she is.

